China 4/14 Strategy



Transform WORLD
NEW GENERATION
RAISING UP CHRIST FOLLOWERS FROM THE 4/14 WINDOW



4-14 China Strategic Plan

Beijing 11 November 2011

Table of Contents

Executive Overview **5**
Discerning the Times – Strategic Research for 4-14 China 5
Challenges: *5*
Opportunities: *5*
Discovering the Tasks: Strategic Objectives for 4-14 China 5
Media to positively Engage Youth *5*
Programs for Youth Development *5*
Family and Marriage Programs *6*
Designing the Tactics: Strategic Programs for 4-14 China 6
Institutional Affiliation *6*
Media Relevance to Help Youth *6*
Family Systems and Improved Function *6*
Development of leadership role models *7*
Need for Life skill development *7*
Resources Available *7*
Baseline Research **8**
Research Summary 8
Challenges *8*
Opportunities *9*
Recommendations *10*
Research Findings 11
Challenges *11*
Opportunities *13*
Recommendations *14*

Analysis of Data to Answer Questions about Youth in China 15
Where do youth and children get their information, and how does it influence their values? 15
What are their values and life goals? 17
What do young people like to do and what are their interests? 17
What influences the self-awareness and confidence of youth? 18
Who are the role models of the young people? 19
What is the disconnection between parents and children? What kind of relationships do young people want with their parents? 19
What gaps exist in the communication and expectations of families with schools and teachers? 20
What communication problems do families have between parents and children? 20
What expectations do society and youth have of children and their parents regarding children's formation, responsibility, and development? 21
What are typical family activities and how much time is allocated to those that are productive? (How do family ideals differ from reality?) 22
How is a child's development influenced by family composition and the gender of teachers? 22
What are parents' and children's attitudes toward love relationships and cohabitation? 22
What is the impact of social status, educational level, and the financial situation of families on children's development? 23
What is the effect of food safety, nutrition, and community security on children? 23
How does urban migration and parents leaving home to work affect children? 23
What effect does dorm culture and peer influence have on college students? 24
What resources in the university are available for students' personal development and how effectively do they learn from experience? 24
How do students plan to handle responsibilities and future plans for when they leave college? 24
What causes some youth to isolate from society? 25
What do youth do in their spare time? 25
What do youth think is boring? 26
What characteristics do youth find attractive in those who work with them? 26
What kind of responsibility are youth willing to accept? 26
What attitude do the university students have towards money? 27
What are youths' attitudes toward honesty, truth, and integrity? 27
In an age of emphasizing information, what methods might work to provide character education in Institutional settings? 27
How do university students view love relationships and cohabitation? 28
What is the biggest pressure facing university students, and how do they view their future? 28
Why do young people believe in the existence of God, but they do not want to pray and read the Bible? 29
What are the TV viewing habits of youth and children? 29
What do they do online and how much time do they spend? 29
What appeal does radio have for youth? 30
What do youth read in a print format, and what do they prefer? *30*
What role do parents play in media choices of youth and children? 30

What international trends and influences are most likely to be integrated into students' lives? 30
What do youth find most appealing in different media? 31
What impact do international influences (media, fashion, and internet) have on children and youth? ... 31

Executive Overview

Statement: Equipping a new generation of children who are 4 to 14 years of age to benefit China

- It is essential to "do something new . . . to build new highways in the wilderness and provide rivers for the deserts" so that youth can be equipped to serve their nation. Through these children "a new generation will be equipped to bring honor and praise[1]" to their nation.
- In order to address the challenge of change in China the needs of all youth must be addressed: urban, rural, migrant and those who parents have moved to urban employment without them.[2]
- Effective planning must include discerning the times, discovering the tasks and designing the tactics.[3]

Discerning the Times – Strategic Research for 4-14 China

Challenges:

- Family Systems are in an era of high transition
- Young people are seeking role models relevant to their concerns
- Children and Youth need social and life skills development in addition to quality education
- Media often promotes values contrary to positive attitudes and behavior in youth
- Traditional institutions struggle to be relevant to the needs of youth

Opportunities:

- Families are looking for resources to promote productive family relationships
- Youth are looking for relevant and interested adults to serve as role models
- Youth want to learn the life-skills to succeed in the future China
- Media can be used to produce positive influence on youth and children
- Youth are prepared to join institutions which support them in their development

Discovering the Tasks: Strategic Objectives for 4-14 China

Media to positively Engage Youth

- Develop appealing music, fashion, internet, movies and stories for Chinese youth
- Adapt international character development media for children and youth
- Develop mobile smart phone apps and web content
- Give youth an opportunity to provide content for media presentations

Programs for Youth Development

- Develop relevant curricula for youth and children
- Identify relevant historical characters as role models
- Provide Meaningful Opportunities to Impact the Community as an Expression of community commitment

[1] Is 43:19-21
[2] Allan Lit – 5 things about China- Macau presentation
[3] 1 Chron. 12:32

- Give children & youth workers better training
- Promote Partnerships

Family and Marriage Programs

- Develop programs that promote family communication and listening
- Develop applications of Emotional Quotient Training for parents
- Offer child development and youth trends resources for parents
- Provide marriage and pre-marital workshops
- Promote family resources and counseling

Designing the Tactics: Strategic Programs[4] for 4-14 China

Institutional Affiliation

- Need to have listeners who will pay attention and give time to youth within the Institution
- Develop institutional responses to the needs of youth as identified by the youth themselves
- Involve youth in finding solutions and preparing programs to help youth
- Curriculum to build self esteem through empowerment and giving responsibility in the institution
- Offer youth opportunity to respond to the social context
- Give youth a better global context to prepare for success through international interaction with positive and constructive international youth networks

Media Relevance to Help Youth

- Design positive play opportunities for children and youth to interact with parents using media
- Create opportunities for children and youth to produce media that can be used and promoted to encourage their creativity
- Identify international media that will encourage positive attitudes and behavior in children and youth; conduct research to see the level of appeal the media will have with youth and children

Family Systems and Improved Function

- Develop affinity groups (groups of men, women and those with similar interests) to help families apply positive ideas that will strengthen relationships
- Organize activities to promote the quality of family life: camps, outing and events for all family members to participate
- Courses for parents on couple's time, weekly family time, building strong parenting role models Emphasize value of relationship in quality of family life

[4] Suggestions from the 4 14 Macau discussions

Development of leadership role models

- Encourage listening mentor relationships
- Encourage new leadership models that emphasize relationship rather than authoritarian and domination models
- Encourage greater awareness among leaders of the challenges faced by youth and children; areas of influence and information
- Relationship is a high value for youth and leaders should become those that youth relate to and are seen as friends
- Help parents become relevant role models and to adapt to the new ways children think and process information; learn to keep up
- Families can serve as role models for other families

Need for Life skill development

- Youth are very social and need to learn effective communication techniques
- Communication techniques that are transparent can be modeled
- Messages from institutions and parents should be informed and authoritative
- Activities such as camps should focus on specific intensive training for life skills and values formation rather than entertainment and lecture
- Give youth opportunity to care for those in need and to volunteer in the community
- Create places where youth have opportunity for counseling on questions, life skills and problems

Resources Available

1. glww.org/china
    - Sunday School materials for children 5-12 years old, teacher books and children's worksheets
        - 8 years of curriculum available
    - Vacation Bible School materials
        - 3 different Vacation Bible school sets
    - Youth Materials
    - 1 year's worth of youth curriculum
        - teacher training book for working with adolescents
    - Books can be ordered on the website and mailed anywhere in the country
2. baojiayin.com
    - Christian books, dvd's and other materials for the family, children and adults
    - all materials are published in China for the Chinese – books from many publishing houses and also the 3-Self are available here
    - orders can be mailed anywhere in the country
3. zdlbooks.com
    - Christian books, dvd's and other materials for the family, children and adults
    - all materials are published in China for the Chinese
4. YTL – Youth on the threshold of Life

- This is a set of materials that can be used by educators in the public schools or in private training centers. It helps young people deal with many issues like true love and friendships.
- It is published by ZDL.

5. Y P R Love – yprlove@126.com –contact Xue Yan (tel: 15040599155)
   - Parents education curriculum, help parents study, understand children and lead them to love God
   - Includes study and application materials
6. Truly Great Kingdom Truths – Constant Lit
   - Curriculum for children and youth 9 and up

Baseline Research

Qualitative methods training in three second tier cities (Changsha, Chengdu, Shenyang) produced fresh insights into the situations faced by children and youth in China. The findings have been validated as relevant to children and youth throughout China and are offered as a market research baseline for the development of Strategies to better serve and design relevant programs for children ages 4-14.

Research Summary

Challenges

1. Family Systems are in an era of high transition
2. Young people are seeking role models relevant to their concerns
3. Children and Youth need social and life skills development in addition to quality education
4. Media often promotes values contrary to positive attitudes and behavior in youth
5. Traditional institutions struggle to be relevant to the needs of youth

1. Family Systems in Transition

- Most parents did not grow up in the context of the "one child" policy
- Both parents work in most families
- An increasing percentage of families are newly arrived "urban citizens"
- In many rural families left behind children live with grandparents

2. Leaders Aren't Youth Role Models

- Youth feel that leaders do not listen to them
- Youth workers are poorly trained to relate to and understand youth and children
- Many adults, including parents and teachers, are perceived as poor role models
- Media promotes more appealing but often negative role models

3. Kids Lack Holistic Development

- School curricula focus on knowledge; youth lack opportunity to acquire life skills training

- Youth have no free time for the development of personal gifts and interests
- Self esteem is based on appearance, grades and possessions
- Without siblings and trusted friends youth lack socialization skills; some isolate
- Sexuality is misunderstood and mismanaged by many youth

4. Media Influenced Values

- Media is highly influential
- On-line media is most frequently accessed and influential of the media
- Media from different sources communicate and promote conflicting values
- Print and news media is perceived by many as manipulative and untrustworthy
- On-line games promote violent and competitive values

5. Institutions Perceived as Irrelevant

- Institutions fear youth: their ideas and push for change
- Institutions are perceived as boring and irrelevant
- Youth workers are generally poorly trained
- Restrictions on youth outreach redirect Institutional resources to safer but less important programs
- Institutions provide too little marriage and childrearing counsel and support

Opportunities

1. Families are looking for resources to promote productive family relationships
2. Youth are looking for relevant and interested adults to serve as role models
3. Youth want to learn the life-skills to succeed in the future China
4. Media can be used to produce positive influence on youth and children
5. Youth are prepared to join institutions which support them in their development

1. Families Want Good Relationships

- Families that are in crisis and change are open to receiving help
- Children want to have close relationships with parents
- Parents want their children to succeed in life
- Parents recognize the need for help in raising children
- Programs to assist families and children are increasingly available

2. Youth Seek Role Model Leadership

- Youth are looking for guidance and advice from adults

- Youth want role models who understand their reality
- Youth seek role models who listen to them and take their ideas seriously
- Leaders among youth place high priority on relationships
- Emotional Quotient theory is an appealing approach

3. Youth Want To Learn Life Skills

- Success in the new China requires a new set of life skills
- Youth have goals for social and material success
- Youth mature earlier but are given responsible roles later
- Youth want to develop their interests and gifts
- Community impact is important

4. Media Can Be Used To Reach Youth

- Media is the primary coping mechanism for stress among youth
- International media is popular and influential and can be adapted to the Chinese market
- The internet is easily accessed by youth and many children
- Most urban youth have mobile smart phones
- On-line messaging is an accepted and popular means of communication
- Youth like stories that mirror their experience

5. Youth & Institutions Need Each Other

- Although not involved in institutions, youth are curious about their role and opportunity
- Youth seek role models who will help develop character
- Youth have good ideas; programs offering personal expression are valued
- Youth seeks counsel for personal problems
- Youth look for ways to influence and help others

Recommendations

1. Use Media to Reach Youth
2. Programs for Development and Empowerment of Youth
3. Programs to Strengthen Family and Marriage

1. Use Media To Reach Youth

- Develop appealing music, fashion, internet, movies and stories for Chinese youth
- Adapt international character development media for children and youth
- Develop mobile smart phone apps and web content

- Give youth an opportunity to provide media content for programs and products

2. Programs for Development and Empowerment of Youth

- Develop relevant curricula for engagement and development of youth and children
- Identify relevant characters as role models
- Provide meaningful opportunities to impact the community as an expression of community care
- Give children and youth workers better training to help youth and children

3. Promote partnerships among organizations working

Research Findings[5]

Challenges

- Parents make decisions based on their own experience, which is significantly different than and therefore irrelevant to children's experience
- Parents have a formal relationship with children, but are not open and genuine with their child
- Children are raised by their grandparents; parents are often absent
- Values between parent and child are very different, and parents do not understand children
  - Parents are uncertain about how to communicate and express love
  - Some parents do not know how to show love through relationship
  - Parents generally do not spend enough time with children, and the time they do spend maybe felt to be critical rather than encouraging by children
  - Youth are over-protected and spoiled by wealthy families, but there is little communication
- Parents are generally unable to provide their children with critical life-skills
  - Parents do not teach youth how to handle money
  - Economic hardship is common for many families
  - Parents have a hard time correcting children and implementing their own experience and life-skills into their family life
- Students lack love from their parents and seek love in relationships to fill this gap.
- Youth don't like to spend time with their parents.
- Parents are over protective and paternalistic leaving little room for healthy relationships with children, so youth become over reliant on parents and lack initiative.
- Parents set an extremely high priority on education and do not understand their children's attitude toward education
- Current education systems focus on grades and entrance exam scores
  - Youth have inadequate assistance in developing social skills

[5] Identified by Educators, youth program workers and leaders and institutional leadership in each of the three second-tier cities.

    - Schools do not provide opportunities for positive socialization; often they promote competition among students
- Youth lack the skills necessary to effectively communicate with adults and thus have no avenue to communicate their concerns
- Youth and parents both experience pressure to succeed in school
- Leaders are unsure as to the best way to influence and lead youth
- Media often defines youth's ideas of what is right and provides role models that are not healthy
- Adults are not necessarily good role models and try dominate children to ensure adult goals are met
- Organizations working with youth are understaffed and cannot effectively address parent issues
- Public lectures for parents and children are sometimes restricted by authorities
- Youth have peer pressure to disregard moral values (like honesty)
- There is a general lack of affirmation for youth in the home and at school
- Society places much higher value on academic achievers and gives them recognition
- Students lack a balanced self-image; they either doubt themselves or are overconfident
- Some youth have no direction and lack self-assurance/confidence or avoid responsibility
- Youth ages 14-18 (high school) do not have much time for anything besides studies
- Youth lack an understanding of personal management and prioritization
- Computer use, online games, cell phone texting and messaging occupy too much time.
- Some students isolate themselves and do not socialize.
- All youth use social networks like QQ and this has a negative influence.
- Studies and homework absorb much of their time.
- Dorm culture has some negative influence on students.
- Students' interests are unrelated to their major; humanities or creative self expression needed.
- Premarital sex is occurring at earlier ages and cohabitation is common.
- Youth think homosexuality is fashionable.
- Rural youth often feel inferior and have greater challenges in the workplace.
- Youth have few specific plans to realize their goals; they are uncertain about the future.
- Youth place too high a value on material wealth.
- Korean and Japanese music and entertainment programs are substitutes for Chinese values and culture.
- Institutions tend to discourage students' activity because youth want to change things
- Institutional programs are boring and have not kept up with students' interests
- Youth workers are not trained to effectively communicate with youth
- Schools tend to control students' access to religious activities and some students feel they are isolated in school
- Youth have little interest in the meaning of life.
- Youth do not find fulfillment in work; they prefer recreation and fun.
- Youth lack values to develop concrete, realistic plans to achieve their goals.
- The saturation of uncontrolled media and conflicting information has led to confusion about values - Internet information is poorly controlled
- Most popular entertainment media has no formative benefit and may be detrimental to development of values.
- Youth have not been well equipped by their parents or society to monitor their own media use.
    - The increased use of cell phones to access most media is much harder to monitor.
    - Parents try to control rather than train children.

- Students are skeptical of media if it seems manipulative.
- The internet has made it easier to plagiarize and cheat in school.
- Radio is generally ineffective to reach youth.
- Physical appearance is valued more highly than integrity.
- Teachers and youth workers are more interested in giving information than in developing relationships.
- College students have too little positive influence and supervision. College students have more free time and need guidance to fill the time positively.

Opportunities

- For those parents who recognize the need to address family issues; there is opportunity for change
- Parents have the opportunity to make a difference in their children's development and achievements
- The society and parents value school grades and academic scores on exams.
- Youth know more about parents than parents know about them.
- Positive influences outside the family exist and may compensate, in some cases, for a lack of parental involvement in a child's development
- Youth have ideals and future objectives.
- Youth desire a close relationship with their parents and seek positive role models who understand the dynamics of their reality
- Youth desire mature, supportive relationships with adults that allow them to express themselves freely and accept them for who they are
- Relationship-building programs are popular amongst youth
- EQ[6] (Emotional Intelligence Quotient) skills to help children develop are being considered and offered by some agencies
- Children mature earlier and would like to be offered opportunity to accept more responsibility and to be involved in community programs
- Youth recognize the need to develop life-skills
- Youth want a safe environment in which to test their gifts and abilities
- Youth can volunteer and show interest in NGO organizations, which are attentive to their development and do not give them routine, boring activities
- Youth recognize the benefit of social, cultural and religious values as helpful for character formation
- In some instances Institutions recognize that they must better understand the feelings of youth to help them
- Institutions can provide opportunities and encourage youth to engage their problems
- Although their time is limited, youth workers respect /love youth and attempt to give youth opportunities to get together, help others, and find meaningful involvement in Institution activities
- Students are open to communication on cell phones by texting and chatting.

[6] Kemper, C. (1999, October). EQ vs. IQ - emotional intelligence, intelligence quotient. *Communication World.*

- Korean and Japanese music and entertainment programs are popular.
- Dorm culture has some positive influence on students.
- Students open up and are transparent about their feelings on internet since they feel secure.
- Children and youth like story telling TV programs about traditional culture.
- Youth have positive goals and ideals; they desire to understand more fully understand themselves.
- Youth seek insight into their personalities and strengths.
- Youth value relationships and express the need to share their experiences with others. Sharing personal experiences is appealing and influences youth.
- Youth use social networking sites like QQ to express themselves.
- College students have more time and are open to new ideas and skills.
- Students want to escape stress and be entertained.
- International media and fashion are highly influential.
- The Internet has made information and knowledge more accessible.
- Youth like to read, but most prefer electronic media.
- Youth like low cost media (boys prefer action media and games, girls prefer relational and romance media and stories).
- Parents express concern that youth appropriately use media to develop their knowledge and skills.

Recommendations

Communication

- Train children how to communicate with parents and show them how to express love
- Parents learn to listen and work together with children (parenting classes)
- Develop community programs for parents who are doing well and those who are willing to change
- Create time and activities for children and parents to develop a close relationship

Develop Skills-Assessment Programs (EQ)

- Help parents learn about and reinforce their children's strengths
- Foster an awareness of the benefit of holistic development
- Develop EQ programs to balance IQ development, and show parents how this can help students succeed in the work place
- Help to develop the youth's idea of justice and helping others using their ideas as starting places for discussion
- Help youth develop a better idea of how to measure success in more than finances
- Help build self image/self esteem
- Help youth identify their strengths/gifts and develop an achievable vision for life

Qualities for Youth Program Leaders

- How to become an appealing role model
- How to communicate with youth
- How to develop and design effective programs

Programs for Youth

- Students should be able to learn together but need to be supervised and facilitated
- Give youth opportunities to make mistakes while supported
- Design attractive, interactive activities that are informative
- Sports and athletic activities could be organized for youth
- Give opportunity for graduate students to share their experience with those in high school and College
- Facilitate youth long-term communication with positive programs through text and Skype
- Develop programs for those working with children and youth (parents, teachers, and youth workers) to help them learn how to relate in order that they better engage with them and shape their values
- Develop better programs to engage and shape the values of college students in their first year
- Develop recreation programs and media that are fun and offer positive values

Media development

- Computer use, online games, cell phone texting and messaging occupy too much time.
- All youth use social networks like QQ and this has a negative influence.
- Korean and Japanese music and entertainment programs are substitutes for Chinese values and culture.
- Television attracts youth; good cartoon (TV) programs can be used for younger children
- Use positive international media, fashion, and the internet as a platform to develop programs to influence children and youth

Analysis of Data to Answer Questions about Youth in China

Where do youth and children get their information, and how does it influence their values?

Traditional sources of information such as the library, magazines, newspapers, and radio still reach some youth in China, but they are becoming much less influential. Television is only viewed by some when riding the bus. The information students rely on is heavily influenced by the information they find online. Although many students indicate that their motivation to be online is to avoid boredom, it then becomes an important part of their daily routine.

Peer conversation topics are influenced by the internet. Since high school and college students get most of their information online, their conversations are based on the same information their friends get, and although some of their information comes from conversations with peers, their parents and through instruction in the classroom, they still acquire much of what they know online.

While students sometimes feel they have too much information, they remain confused about the values, which are important for finding how they should live in modern China. Despite their ready access to information, students often feel that the information they need to make decisions about life is hard to find. While media exerts an influence on their values, it has not clarified them or assisted youth in developing a helpful set of life principles. The emphasis of media and advertising

has encouraged materialism as a common value, yet they report that they feel empty, anxious, and unsatisfied. There is also some indication that media encourages experimentation with gender roles, and for some, raises questions about their sexual identity as they develop.

For middle school students, TV is the primary source of media information since parents are more likely to restrict and monitor the internet use of younger students. It is viewed as a way to pass time or release stress. TV remains an important source of information and entertainment, although it was voiced several times that TV news and information is sometimes a source of stress and thought to be biased and distorted. TV is also thought to exert a counterproductive influence on the values and emotions of children and youth and is viewed by some as a waste of time. Much of the TV viewed by young people is comedy and entertainment shows, often Korean and Taiwanese style, which encourage a superficial understanding of life and a distorted view of reality.

Although in the past the Internet was primarily accessed by online computers, increasingly cell phones have become a common way to find information on the World Wide Web. The Internet and cell phones are also a primary means of communicating and sharing with friends (sometimes with parents) and increases their knowledge of life. Since much of their information about life comes from the experiences of friends and what they find out from others, social network sites such as QQ, Renren, and others are a primary source of information. It is important to note that most students judge the accuracy of any media information by their own experience and that of their peers.

The internet is helpful for school work as it offers ready access to global information on any subject. However, it is also reported that students will use papers or reports they find on the internet and pass them off as their own work. This is an example of the difficulty in controlling its appropriate use by students. They also acknowledge that even though they feel they should avoid such sites, pop-up ads attract them to websites that offer information detrimental to their positive formation. It was suggested by adults and students that there is currently inadequate regulation and control of the Internet.

Some believe that there is a benefit made possible because of the Internet provides freedom of expression in the form of forums and blogs that discuss truth and encourage creative thought. Despite the observation that this might provide a helpful option for critique of society, it is also frequently noted that these forums become negative and lack genuine opportunities for dialogue as in some cases they become extreme and abusive. It was also mentioned that ideas for crime, perversion, and violence could be encouraged by the Internet activities; this includes violence in net-based and interactive games.

Overall, students are increasingly skeptical of much of the information they are given, whether it is in school classes (some say the content of the classes is not practical), from parents, or even media. While most of their information comes from their experience and that of their peers, they find out about dating from parents and gather useful information in school from teachers who are interesting and informative.

What are their values and life goals?

Generally, youth are not interested in the meaning of life and would rather try to gain from their community than contribute to it. While there are some who want to make a difference in the community and express noble goals, they generally want to help the community after they are established and have financial security. The overall attitude is that they should be able to have all they want while having fun, not held to be responsible and not working too hard; authority figures and personal or communal restrictions are seen as obstacles to these priorities.

The goals of youth are similar to those of their parents and teachers although their values are dissimilar. Goals and views about "success" generally fall into two categories; youth seek to balance these to find satisfaction with life. The first goal is social fulfillment: to have close, trusting, non-judgmental relationships with friends, family, and in their own marriages. The second is material success which means to care for themselves and family by getting into a good career, buying things they want, and having enough money to be comfortable and do the things that appeal to them.

In order to accomplish these goals they hope to get an education, succeed in business, contribute to their community, and develop meaningful social contacts with people they like and admire. Some feel this can be accomplished through a political career, others by starting a business, marrying into a rich family, or completing an advanced degree, preferably including international study.

They value freedom, an easy job with high salary, going to a good university, and having a close-knit family – all of which imply a certain degree of incompatibility and rely on wishful thinking rather than concrete plans. They want to be part of a group that is nontraditional, accepts and encourages their unique personalities, and helps to solve problems through power and quick thinking. This self-interest is, in part, attributable to media influences which engender their conflicting priorities and unrealistic goals. Media tends to emphasize personal appearance rather than character and integrity, and as a result, youth are confused and uncertain about how they should accomplish their goals. While some are optimistic about the future, others are despondent and feel that they will never be able to accomplish their goals.

What do young people like to do and what are their interests?

Youth in China, particularly those in Middle and High school, are primarily responsible to study and prepare for exams. Due to this overwhelming emphasis on education, most do not enjoy study, unhappily comply with these demands, and resent what they believe to be restrictions on their options. They feel that these activities inhibit their pursuit of personal development and interests.

As a result, they like to engage in activities that do not resemble school and fulfill personal interests. These include interaction with and consumption of media such as: music, TV, video games, surfing the internet, going to movies, and reading fashion magazines, anime, and youth-life story books. Despite some restrictions on their freedom to pursue social activities, they are also active with friends and enjoy playing games, engaging in sports (ping pong, soccer, badminton), watching sports events, cos-play (dressing as anime characters), fashion dressing, playing cards, partying, playing internet games, and chatting on the internet or phone SMS/texting. They also either enjoy

or would like to travel and learn more about the world, and this is part of the reason they avidly follow the lives of national and international movie stars, musicians, and athletes.

What influences the self-awareness and confidence of youth?

There are challenges for young people as they seek to find their identity and self awareness; in the cases of those who do not navigate these challenges, a lack of self assurance results. Youth and college students feel they have no voice in their life and are not listened to by either parents or teachers. Since their lives are governed by rules at school and parents ideals at home, there is little support for independent thinking and when faced with decisions outside of these contexts youth experience confusion and doubt over their choices. In reaction to the sense of limited personal freedom, students report that they do not talk about anything but superficial concerns with their parents. This means that in their most crucial decisions, they are left to their own wisdom or that of their peers.

Two primary areas create additional pressures in become self aware and confident: (1) rapid changes in the Chinese socio-economic situation and (2) the narrow focus on measurement of success based solely on their exam scores and the impact of these results on subsequent placement in schools or jobs.

The media exposes young people to national and international crises, which reinforce the sense of insecurity they already feel due to the changes in society and within their families. The family dynamics of the child with two parents and four grandparents increases their socialization with adults, but also creates a sense that adults are in control and children have no power to make their own decisions. This is further reinforced by doting grandparents, who are often the primary care-givers and do not expect a child to do anything for themselves but succeed in school with high grades. Parents are often both working one or more jobs and do not have time to invest in a relationship with their child. If the child is not perceived to be living up to the parents' expectations, the response is often extreme and this further erodes the confidence of a struggling student. With parents away from home and in most cases with no siblings in the home, young people feel isolated and lonely. As the only child on whom the family's future rests, they worry about their capacity to meet family expectation for financial success and social status in the future. The socio-economic changes that have occurred over the past decade mean that the gap between the way youth view life and the way in which parents view it is increasingly wider. Parents do not understand the child and the child lives in a world no longer similar to that which the parent experienced thirty or forty years ago.

Schools are primarily tasked with preparing children to pass exams. There are few opportunities in the curriculum for values development and organizations that provide programs of personal development for children are limited. The extra-curricular activities in school tend to focus on a school's specialization, which marginalizes students who do not have an aptitude to succeed in a particular area. The method of instruction in schools and the style of interaction with the adults at home mean students gain little real understanding of life's challenges and how to deal with setbacks. This is further exacerbated by the lack of guidance counselors and mentors in the schools and community.

Students indicate that there are too few opportunities in their lives to explore their interests and discover their aptitude. Once identified, this knowledge would give them a sense of accomplishment as an individual. Since scores on exams are their primary means of other and self assessment, students compete with one another to gain better scores and this delays the process of learning how to develop positive peer socialization; young people compare themselves and their success primarily within this frame of reference. This pressure to successfully achieve high scores in school defines and limits students' goals. They continue to be dominated by this criterion of success until they have either failed out of school or are forced to leave either by completion or failure and enter society as a productive adult; in either case, they are not well equipped to succeed.

Who are the role models of the young people?

Youth seem to respect and look up to famous people who are attractive and financially successful. However, they admire traits such as being a positive influence in the community and living a rounded, interesting, colorful, and fulfilled life. They admire those who portray a strong leader, one who fights for justice even if they use illegal means. They like people who show that they have close groups of trusted friends and do not put themselves forward or brag about themselves. Youth also admire teachers and leaders who respect and understand youth by taking time to develop a personal relationship.

What is the disconnection between parents and children? What kind of relationships do young people want with their parents?

Overall, the generation gap is due to the inability of parents to communicate with their children and of children to voice their opinions. Children and youth have a different set of values than their parents, and are shaped to a much greater degree by media and international values than their parents were. Children do not see the relevance of the history that shaped their parents' lives, and as a result, parents' attempts to communicate are often ignored. Parents reject children's interests and activities without trying to understand why they have these interests. Young people said their parents spend too little time with their children to really understand their children. Children feel that too much of what they hear from parents is scolding, judgment, nagging, and insults.

Often parents do not share with the children the problems their family is facing, and in this attempt to protect them, they further isolate the children in a world not connected to the problems and conflict of adult reality. Children are not certain that the family is secure, and some fear that the family and parents' marriage are at risk. Parents think that when they give children material things, they are expressing love, but youth crave emotional support and time from their parents.

Youth feel their parents do not know how to train and develop their children, and that they only want to control children rather than share with them as a team. Youth say their parents are not aware of the talents and interests of their children. Youth feel that their parents pressure them to succeed in ways important to the older generation and not that of their children. When they are not affirmed by parents, children seek affirmation in other ways – with peers, on the internet, or through computer game conquests.

Some youth have given up on family; they report that they no longer communicate with their parents, and as a result, some do not want a family of their own. Youth said that they want their parents to be more like friends: open, accepting, and forgiving. They hope to be respected and loved, even if they make a mistake or a bad decision. They do not think that a family should not complain and fight.

Youth want parents to provide structure and direction for children without controlling them. Youth said while they recognize the importance of financial security for the family, they would like their fathers to communicate more with them and share in good relationships. They would like to have activities where the family can learn together and where they are able contribute to the family's security.

What gaps exist in the communication and expectations of families with schools and teachers?

Parents believe that schools should be able to help their child develop academically and pass the examinations with good scores. To this end, parents are generally supportive of education. However, since they think schools are responsible for education, they may blame the teachers and school system when students are low performers or fail to meet academic expectations. Parents also indicate that the current education system is poor at preparing youth for reality and handling the problems society will offer when schooling is complete.

Students complain that sometimes parents use connections or money to gain admission for their child into better schools. This means that the school system itself is negatively affected by carrying students who do not have the capacity to take advantage of the better schools. Students also indicate that exam scores are over emphasized by both teachers and parents and other measures of success and capacity ignored. Although students often hear it said that education is the means of getting ahead, they do not find this aphorism to be credible. Some parents agree that education does not guarantee success for students as they leave school.

Teachers also indicate that parents are committed to the goals of the child achieving good scores but are not always cooperative when it comes to helping the teachers work with children. The teachers feel that the family is a very important part of children's education but that some parents do not support teachers' efforts, in some cases even lying to protect a child from the consequences of not completing their homework. On the other hand, parents give examples of the teachers encouraging students to lie about whether a school is provide good quality services rather than be honest about their true opinions and observations.

What communication problems do families have between parents and children?

While some subjects report a high degree of interaction with parents the data indicates that serious problems of family communication are prevalent. Parents have little quality time with children and the kids do not communicate on important things with parents. Most communication during the time they have together, meals and washing up, is about issues determined to be "safe" and unlikely to upset anyone. Parents acknowledge that they need more time with the children and some

attempt to go shopping or to a movie with their child. Most often youth indicate they avoid doing things with parents.

This may in part be due to the feeling parents have that they must encourage their child to succeed in school by any means possible; a sense that is encouraged and promoted by teachers and schools. The result however is that youth avoid situations in which they are "nagged" to do more. Some parents are aware that children are more enthusiastic and compliant when engaged in activities they have chosen but other parents feel it best to choose for the child and hope they will appreciate the encouragement. Young people generally react negatively to such paternalistic approaches and communication is further handicapped by their resentment. Parents' understanding of the child is limited since children live in a much different socio-economic reality than the parents did when they were children.

Parents indicate that the only responsibility expected of a child is to do well in school. Students feel that this limits their capacity to develop and that school is a poor guarantee of future success. This difference in basic assumptions has a negative influence on the family communication. Children and parents have so little in common that there is little to talk about. Some parents notice that girls are easier to talk to than boys, which may account for the better social development of girls noted by many. Because there is so little communication with parents, teachers indicate that children grow up with a very narrow view of life and have not been exposed to the realities and responsibilities of adult life.

What expectations do society and youth have of children and their parents regarding children's formation, responsibility, and development?

Society expects parents to provide the environment in which children can be prepared for an education and to encourage their children to excel in their work. Parents are generally conservative and set the same standards for their children as were expected of them. Although some of the parents who were subjects in this study indicate that they hope their children will enjoy life and prepare to find fulfillment rather than a high paying job, most of the data indicate this attitude is not perceived to be common for parents. Parents are expected to provide material and emotional support for children in their home. Society also considers it usual for parents to use their connections and influence to get kids into good schools. Generally parents are expected to set goals and direct the choices of children toward this single purpose. A child's development is measured by scholastic success. Ultimately the parents' support and encouragement to achieve high scores in school is anticipated to help the child get good scores in school, find placement in a good college, get a good job, marry well, and take care of the parents when they are old.

Children expect their parents to help them find fulfilling jobs, define their skills and aptitudes and interact in a relational and supportive fashion. They would like to have parents converse with them as they converse with friends, without judgment and demands and to interact with humor about topics of common interest. Some parents and students indicate that this is the relationship they have and these children seem more likely to accept guidance and advice from their parents. Youth expect parents to provide discipline but want it to be consistent and constructive. They also think that there is a point at which parents treat young people as persons able to make their own

decisions and to support them as they make their mistakes without judgment. Youth indicate that a good relationship with parents will help them face the future with greater certainty and confidence. They want parents to love them openly, provide a secure environment, and interact with them rather than attempt to control and dominate.

What are typical family activities and how much time is allocated to those that are productive? (How do family ideals differ from reality?)

Ideals for family time are not clearly defined nor are there consistent patterns. However, it is consistently indicated that parents spend too little time with children. This is in part due to the children's assigned time taken up with weekend and evening classes, both parents' work, and household responsibilities. It was reported that the time for most conversation is during meals or cleaning up in the evening.

Although a number of young people indicate that they don't want to go out with parents on weekends, suggestions for family time together included: watching TV or movies, shopping, having family meetings, and various recreational activities such as: going to the park, swimming, taking holidays, or camping.

How is a child's development influenced by family composition and the gender of teachers?

The family composition of a child having two parents and four grandparents affects children negatively if they are over indulged. I was also suggested that this family composition offers greater psychological support. It is reported that fathers who are absent or do not spend time with their children have a negative effect on the child's development. It also was noted that after a divorce only one parent stays involved with the child, leaving a gap in their social and psychological formation. Children generally appear to be better adjusted if they have positive, mutually respectful relationships with parents. One single parent said that although she had done her best, her son turned on her and disrespects her.

The education system generally can be described as a system of rules to be followed and does little to contribute to the development of critical or independent thinking. It is also observed that it is a better environment for girls than boys as there are more female teachers to provide role models. As boys get older, they find it more difficult to communicate with female teachers.

What are parents' and children's attitudes toward love relationships and cohabitation?

Parents are against early dating and development of romantic relationships. They want appropriate or positive friends for their children and see these activities as distractions for their child. However, students report that dating is common in high school and blind dates are common for those seeking marriage. Sometimes dating is socially competitive and reported to lead to conflict and fights.

Traditional values seem to have been lost and this shift in the values of college students may be attributable to international media and western standards regarding these issues. Although students hold mixed attitudes toward cohabitation, most view this practice as common and are non-

judgmental; it does not seem to be a moral concern. For them the primary concern about dating and cohabitation is the possibility that there will be emotional stress and that this will interfere with studies. Most view decisions about love relationships and cohabitation with pragmatism and feel it is important that relationships not get in the way of success in life. Some even express the view that homosexuality is not inappropriate. Marriage is seen as problematic and while some feel that cohabitation is only for marriage, others seek relationships for companionship. They think that cohabitation has less pressure than marriage and some suggest that marriage may result in more stress and trouble than cohabitation.

What is the impact of social status, educational level, and the financial situation of families on children's development?

Families with higher social status are aware of opportunities and able to get their children into better schools.

Similarly, wealthy families are able to secure places in good schools for children, but are reported as less likely to pass on a good work ethic. Often their socio-economic status produces materialism, entitlement, and dependence in their children. Poorer and rural families have greater financial pressures but are also observed to have children with a stronger work ethic and who study harder. Poor families are more likely not to get their children into better schools either through lack of resources or a lack of knowledge about opportunities.

Parents with better education are more familiar with the parenting techniques and are able to identify the opportunities within the education system. These parents are also better equipped to help their children learn outside of school. It appears that parents with lower education may have lower expectations for educational success. Although many aspire to upward mobility, they are less likely to be aware of how best to assist their children.

What is the effect of food safety, nutrition, and community security on children?

Parents want their children to be healthy and safe. Although schools provide meals these may provide less nutrition and quality than needed. It was noted that urban children seem more likely to get better nutrition than rural children. Urban parents monitor and control their children since they live in neighborhoods with poor safety. One example was the suggestion that many parents and grandparents need to meet kids at school to escort them home.

Children both benefit from and are spoiled by the common family composition of one child with two parents and four grandparents. More emotional and material resources are available in these families, but often without the accompaniment of character building discipline.

How does urban migration and parents leaving home to work affect children?

Overall, it was noted that children raised in rural areas are perceived to be more honest. Additionally, it appears that rural areas still represent traditional Chinese values to a greater degree than urban areas. When adult urban migration occurs the child is often left behind with the grandparents. Generally when parents are away working, grandparents are more involved than

parents in raising children and more likely to spoil them. Children who accompany their parents to urban areas may find admission to schools to be difficult. The rural students who are educated in the city and cannot find work also find it difficult to return home to rural areas.

What effect does dorm culture and peer influence have on college students?

Some students use the dorm to avoid going to class. Dorm is like a small family and offers opportunity for socialization and development, bad peer relationships are an obstacle to success. Friends can be a preferred alternative to relationships with parents, although relationships with peers can be complicated and tolerance is needed. Peers do not necessarily contribute to an understanding of life, but peers can be an encouragement. Some parents want to meet their child's peers and get to know them. Peers are social company for conversation and offer emotional security.

What resources in the university are available for students' personal development and how effectively do they learn from experience?

Students indicate that good teachers are very important. The teacher's character is evaluated based on how well a teacher relates to the students. Students appreciate receiving support and praise from teachers and those who have good communication skills and discuss interesting and relevant things are popular. Students indicate that in college, professors are less approachable and that they learn less when the professor rushes out of the class without offering time with the students. Students' unions offer opportunities to gain management and communication skills and fellowship groups are important opportunities for outings and positive social interaction. Students value exchange programs and indicate that foreign teachers help them develop new ideas and better understand the world outside of the local community. Some students expressed a need for more humanities courses.

Students also learn from experiences. Even natural disasters and phenomenon are reported as helping shift attitudes toward spirituality and social responsibility. Their experience with friends helps them to develop socialization skills and think through their decisions. For many there is an increasing dependence on virtual experience through media (TV, movies, and music). Computer games provide experience of virtual worlds that simulate reality for those who cannot experience it because of restrictions, limitations, or because they have withdrawn from reality. These media shape attitudes and values and many of the adults feel the influences are primarily negative.

How do students plan to handle responsibilities and future plans for when they leave college?

While in high school and the junior and senior years of college, students are very focused on scores for examinations. Their primary responsibility is to study. Those who are unable to continue with school or are completing their studies then have the responsibility of finding employment. They hope to find a job that is meaningful and fulfilling but most do not think this is a reality.

Overall, students are uncertain about the future. Some believe that school is not really preparing them to succeed in the market place and are worried that they will not be able to handle the

responsibilities of a career. Others seem to believe that based on their education they should be given a high paying job and advancement and are not prepared to prove themselves in the work place. Some parents and youth workers feel it would be helpful if youth were also prepared for the workplace through leadership and management courses provided either in school or by NGO agencies.

Youth see marriage as a responsible relationship and a challenge. Many have seen their own parents' marriages as relationships that are filled with conflict and many that end in divorce. Finding a compatible marriage partner seems a challenge and some indicate that remaining single or cohabitation may be options they would consider.

Few have structured plans and believe that plans need to be made in context of the opportunities and challenges that arise. These tend to make decisions as they go along with few clear goals or plans. Others have very clearly formulated plans, although they are often not realistic. Generally they hope for financial security; some think that there own business or working for a foreign company provides the best opportunities. There are some who recognize that they will need to take starter jobs that provide experience, and in these jobs the financial reward will be lower but provide an opportunity to learn work skills and build their experience. While most believe that money is very important others feel that satisfaction with life (marriage, career, religious experience, and place in the community) are more important and should be a primary consideration.

What causes some youth to isolate from society?

A big factor for those who isolate is that they have no time due to studies. However, many also lack self-confidence and communication skills in a competitive social environment. They do not have friends they can trust and there is competition among schoolmates that is stressful. It is easier for these young people to spend time on the computer, watching TV, or playing video games.

For others, their neighborhoods are not safe and they fear taking public transportation at certain times. It was noted that in Changsha, relations tend to be somewhat confrontational and those lacking self-confidence shy away from exposure to potential unpleasant interactions. They may also be afraid of being misunderstood, and so do not want to reveal their true thoughts.

The generation gap induces feelings that they are not understood and some avoid communicating with adults. Parents dominate so much of their life that some youth do not have a personal identity; poor relationships with parents may also influence them to isolate. Rural girls, in particular, seem to report that they do not feel valued and have a poor self-image, which further isolates them. Some said their parents have embarrassed them in front of friends and teachers, and this may contribute to a lack of confidence in public. Some said that their family experiences influence them to want to stay single because they do not feel equipped to deal with relationships.

What do youth do in their spare time?

Youth want to be busy and active. Although adults think of youth as lazy and self-indulgent because they like to sleep late, surf the internet, play computer games, watch movies and TV, listen to music, read comics, eat, and shop, these are merely activities they see as rewards for studying or because

there is nothing else to do. Youth use these activities to socialize, as well as spending time with friends on text or chat, watching sports, and participating in sports. They also want to do things with their family like learning to cook and drive or travel on vacation. They have an interest in self development activities such as learning foreign languages, working a part-time job, preparing for exams, and doing community service activities. Above all, they do not like to be told what to do or when to do it; these activities are their primary opportunities to assert themselves in a social context where they are constantly told what to do.

What do youth think is boring?

Some said that life is boring. Generally, boredom is either a result of either too few activities or activities that do not seem relevant or are disturbing. They tend to avoid criticism and conflict. They do not like situations in which they are not listened to or their ideas are dismissed without serious consideration. In the context of a society that is not very open to interaction, they are sometimes given information that they question. If they are told things they doubt, they also want to be given an opportunity to question or investigate what was said.

Meetings bore them where there is not much activity, and they avoid or turn off their attention when they are talked to with no chance to respond. When the communication is all *to* them rather than an exchange of information, they become bored. If the activities or information given is perceived not to be practical and applicable to their lives, they are quickly bored; generally, they feel education falls into this category. They try to avoid events that create additional stress, pressure, or expectations in their lives. They look for activities that are relevant to their interests, questions, or concerns and from which they can learn to succeed.

What characteristics do youth find attractive in those who work with them?

Youth need to be led by those who respect them and pay attention to their ideas and thoughts. They value people who are willing to take the time to listen, so they are able to discover their abilities and talents. They like to interact with those who lead them and who do so with humor, praise for their successes, and forgiveness when they fail. They expect leaders to frame the program at home and in public with clear direction and consistency, but not to try to take advantage of them. They admire those who provide good examples and are loyal, do not betray trust, or reveal their confidences to others.

They would like to think of their parents, teachers, and youth leaders as friends who want to understand them. They want to experience life guided by those who care for them, but do not pressure them. This requires patience and interest in their personal lives and thoughts. They want to be with people who do things that are active; they do not want to sit while someone preaches at them. In this way, they will be happy to learn and develop good values in the context of loving relationships rather than those that are competitive and quarrelsome.

What kind of responsibility are youth willing to accept?

Youth are neither sure of what is expected from them, nor that they can handle the responsibilities of the real world. They are willing to accept the responsibility they have for their families, respect the elderly, protect their younger friends and acquaintances, and would like to start businesses.

They also hope to engage in enterprise, or serve the community through involvement with institution and organizations for social good.

Although they are not sure of their talents or opportunities, they want to accept responsibility in areas where they can succeed. However, they are not willing to accept responsibility for things in which they have no say and see no benefit. They also seem to avoid responsibility when they are not sure they can succeed or for things that they have not been equipped to do well. They say that responsibility can only be undertaken when they have established their own security. After taking care of themselves, they hope to help others in the community who need help and have good friends who support each other and learn together. They plan to spend more time with the family and help parents solve family problems when they have the opportunity.

What attitude do the university students have towards money?

They want to make lots of money, and the possession of wealth is a standard for success; without money, you cannot do anything for anyone. However, for many it is difficult to make money, and parents put priority and great pressure on their children to make money. Although they want to make money, many cannot manage it well when they have it. Some said success is more than just making money, it is a means to a better end and do not find it attractive when people talk about money all the time. While they think corruption is wrong when they see it in others, they may be willing to accept its necessity for themselves.

What are youths' attitudes toward honesty, truth, and integrity?

Students do not feel that it is necessary to be honest. Some said that to be honest makes it impossible to be successful and others that you need to protect yourself, so sometimes you have to lie. It was felt that there are times to be honest and other times when it was foolish and naïve to be truthful.

In an age of emphasizing information, what methods might work to provide character education in Institutional settings?

Youth, in the age of information, have a high priority on communication that flows both ways; they want to hear, but even more, they want to be heard. The programs should help students learn, but equally give them an opportunity to give their opinions and ideas. Overall, they want to be involved in helping others and finding fulfillment and success for themselves. The activities should not appear to be another training; they already feel that they have too much information forced on them that others feel is important. Rather, the programs should give them opportunity for self-expression – experiencing life in an environment where they can learn and have the opportunity to lead. Whether at home, school, or institution, it is important that they are able to evaluate the success of their efforts and learn life lessons from either success or failure in these programs.

Parents, teachers, or youth leaders who are involved in programs with youth should be good examples of a balanced life. These leaders must use the program to show that everyone (including leaders) has problems, and that problems are only effectively resolved by application of good character. As such, adults should not come across as having all the answers or knowing what needs

to be done in every situation; adults are not God, they make mistakes too. Adults must also model getting along with others, not quarreling or competing, whether in the home or in public institutions. The long-term consequences of good and bad decisions should be evaluated, so children and youth begin to recognize that there are long-term consequences for every decision.

Youth see themselves as individuals who have distinct interests and personality. Programs that treat them as a group are less likely to be appealing. Interaction also gives opportunity for youth and adults to learn the areas of each child's individual strengths and interests. Youth should be involved in designing the programs expected to attract them and keep their attention. All activities should be planned for the most possible interaction. In family time, parents should listen to the children and together evaluate suggestions made by the children. In this way, they learn to accept responsibility and become good leaders. Adults should show that they love and value the children and youth in order to avoid appearing to take advantage of them. Youth need programs that give opportunities to serve others at home and in the community. They will then see the difference character makes as they are involved and responsible for these programs.

How do university students view love relationships and cohabitation?

Students say that this is a topic that everybody thinks and talks about, but on which there is no consensus on the right way to handle this area. The analysts for the project think that the cohabitation of students is quite common. The students themselves differ widely on how best to approach the idea of pre-marital relationships; some think it is okay if you really love the other person, some feel society should be more open and accept the reality of divorce, cohabitation, and homosexuality, some that it is good to experiment before settling down, while others think it is always wrong or a source of stress to be avoided.

Analysts suggest that many university students do not really believe in true love, but maintain an illusion of the ideal in short-term relationships. However, many continue to have high ideals for their spouse and future marriage. Generally, girls are more conservative and try to protect themselves, while boys are more liberal.

What is the biggest pressure facing university students, and how do they view their future?

Much of the pressure in their lives is directly or indirectly connected to their desire to succeed financially. Since it is hard to find a job and to open their own business, they have pressure to achieve ideals like home ownership that appear to be very difficult to attain. They are pressured by their own ideals and aspirations, and become discouraged when it seems they will not succeed.

They also have pressure from relationships with friends and family. The competitiveness of school is a big pressure, especially for those who do not consistently apply themselves except when the exams create a motivational crisis. Some do not know what to do and have no clear direction for their life. Since they feel they have no control over the circumstances of their lives, some escape into the virtual worlds of video games and the internet. They are pressured by their peer and social expectations, and some express that their faith and hopes might be lost to the pressures of society.

Why do young people believe in the existence of God, but they do not want to pray and read the Bible?

Many do not have a clear idea of God. They are told that God is like a father, but their parents, especially their fathers, are harsh, critical, and not supportive. Parents are often not good role models of prayer and Scripture reading. They do not have evidence or experience of God helping them, and those who want to be independent think it is not good to rely on God. Most do not see how Christian practice is connected to the reality of everyday life.

What are the TV viewing habits of youth and children?

Students are particularly interested in the physical appearance of stars, romance plots, idol talent programs, and comedy. However, it is important to note that they generally prefer internet over TV and, when it is possible, they are online.

Because the lives of middle and high school children are occupied with studies, they normally only have time to watch TV only on the weekends and holidays. Children and youth do watch some history and information programs on TV with their families.

The Chinese government regulates TV programming in order to encourage awareness of Chinese culture and promote awareness of its importance to the Chinese people. However, for young people, TV is a form of relaxation or escape from the pressures of school, and generally TV is an opportunity to be entertained. Cartoons, animation, and entertainment shows like “Happy Boys” and “Super Girls” are favorites. Many of the most watched TV shows are those that are either modeled after Korean or Taiwanese programs or originate from these areas.

What do they do online and how much time do they spend?

Youth spend as a much time as possible online either on their cell phones or a computer. Younger children have less time online as they are restricted by their parents, usually to half an hour, and are often monitored while online. When online, students of all ages play games, chat with friends on social network sites, watch movies and videos, read online novels, listen to music, and search for information. The information searches might include finding material to help with studies, monitoring trends in areas of interest, getting information about star personalities, following sports scores and games, or to keeping up with world news. However, the most common reason to be online is to relieve stress or avoid boredom.

It was noted that for some, the online sites and forums provide an opportunity to express anger and discontent with life or national and international events. This can be positive, but often leads to unhealthy extremes. Similarly, online gaming can be a simple way to relax, but may become addictive, create a false sense of success when winning, and lead to a cyber reality that is filled with violence, crime, and conquest.

Additional online activities for students include socialization (sending visual gifts and greetings), writing blogs, and chatting. They also do more shopping online. Unfortunately, students are also susceptible to the pop-up ads that bring them to sites such as porn websites and other sites, which are distractions and often contribute to addictive internet activity.

What appeal does radio have for youth?

Generally, radio is a media that no longer is a significant part of the media experience of youth. Music is the radio programming most often listened to by youth, although online music is replacing even the popular on-air DJs. However, comedy programs such as Dabing's jokes and others are mentioned as radio programs that appeal to youth. They also listen to and participate in late night call-in programs, which offer advice to callers on their problems and serve as sounding boards for them to air problems or concerns.

What do youth read in a print format, and what do they prefer?

Youth have little personal spending money to buy print media; much of their preferred media consumption is essentially free online or in the form of inexpensive print media. Newspapers are infrequently read, and except for text books, most books are now available in electronic formats. Magazines, anime books, and Reader's Digest books are still read, but for some a print media they like is the micro or palm-size books that can easily be carried and read when online novels are not accessible.

The material that is most popular and offered as print media are romance novels for girls and Kungfu novels for boys, which sometimes have pornographic content or implications. Youth will also read global news magazines featuring information on music, movie stars, fashion, or popular youth culture. Students read cartoons and high school and college students also read light literature, although it was observed that high school students in particular have very little time for leisure reading.

What role do parents play in media choices of youth and children?

Parents hope that media will help a child acquire life skills through its use and also permit students to do online research for school. Parents often exert control over TV viewing and frequently monitor the amount of time and internet sites that children use if viewed at home. More easily controlled media choices are younger children's media use: reading, TV viewing, and online activity. However, they are unable to monitor cell phone media use, and as children grow older, they have more freedom from parents and are more likely to make their own choices about what they do online, watch on TV, or read.

Parents allow children to watch some cartoons, but are more likely to encourage educational, history or science channels on TV, world masterpiece programs, presentations of Chinese classic books, and stories of heroes who have contributed to Chinese culture. If TV viewing is a family activity, younger children are more likely to watch parents' choice of TV programs.

What international trends and influences are most likely to be integrated into students' lives?

Since the Chinese movies seem naïve when compared to American movies, analysts suggest that college students prefer foreign language movies or shows even when dubbed or available only in the original language. TV programs and the Internet are the most readily available international media for youth in China. Music from Hong Kong, Korea, and America are popular; Japanese anime

cartoons, Korean TV, and American movies are also popular media. Since many children only speak or understand Mandarin, stars and TV program MCs who are Chinese or programs that are dubbed into Chinese have more influence than those that are subtitled.

Korean clothes and hairstyles set the fashion trends for many youth. It is also noted that, to some extent, the influence of foreign media and sexual activities portrayed in American movies and on TV have resulted in more permissive sexual attitudes and behaviors in Chinese youth.

What do youth find most appealing in different media?

Youth find websites or programs that purport to give them insights into their personalities, decisions in life, or offer guidance appealing. They are avid consumers of social network sites such as QQ or Renren, as they are able to readily access online "friends" who can share insights, opinions, and perspectives on life. They like media sources that might help them achieve success in business and relationships or expose them to the world beyond their local and national experience.

Students do not generally care about news media or media that seem to control or limit their rights and newfound freedoms. They want to be able to compare alternate views or reports, so they often seek their information online where they are able to compare alternate presentations of the facts.

Media that is low cost or free, like the cell phones that parents pay for, are appealing and important to children and youth. These media are used to help them with school projects, offer access to music of interest, socialize with friends, and permit escape into a virtual world (such as that found on video games).

The appeal of glamour as portrayed in TV, movies, and on the Internet has very significant influence on youth. This affects fashion trends, how youth spend their money, and shapes their values. Youth also find media that are counter-cultural, non-mainstream, or controversial appealing. There is interest in humor, which caricatures the typical attitudes and behaviors; this humor focuses on the physical attributes or behaviors of those who are considered to be different.

What impact do international influences (media, fashion, and internet) have on children and youth?

International influences are stronger in urban than rural settings and these influences affect adults and youth. Although there are some restrictions on their internet access, they are very influenced by international media and fashions. This influence is noted even by those who do not approve of the loss of typical Chinese values as a result of increased shift to non-Chinese influences. It is clear that Asian nations, such as South Korea and Japan, have a strong influence on even the music, fashions, and TV shows produced in China. Western music, American sitcoms, and movies are also followed. International fast food is popular with children and college students, and has changed the way youth eat, what they eat, and the beverages they enjoy. Younger children like the playground and kids' meal toys they find, and older students like the ambiance and the quick, cheap food experience.

Korean fashion, soap operas, and TV shows are followed and imitated. Japanese anime books and TV shows are influential and young people engage in *cos-play* (dressing up as anime and movie

characters – Avatar, etc.). They also watch TV programs, both broadcast and on-line, originating from many countries.

An additional international influence is found in on-line opportunities to communicate with international friends through e-mail, Skype, and QQ (Chinese Facebook). Foreign university teachers are also popular figures with college students and often expose them to new ways of looking at themselves, the world, and the problems they face.